

Challenges and how I overcome:

**1. Wrong syntax while editing XML config files** While editing core-site.xml and hdfs-site.xml, I missed closing some tag properly, which caused Hadoop to throw a parsing error on startup. I carefully rechecked the XML structure, matched every opening tag with its closing tag, and validated it by re-running start-dfs.sh, the error disappeared and services started normally.

**2. Changes in config files not taking effect** After editing mapred-site.xml, the new settings didn't seem to apply. I realized I forgot to restart the Hadoop services after saving the file. Once I stopped and restarted using stop-dfs.sh / start-dfs.sh, the updated configuration was picked up correctly.